In this critical juncture of Babur's life, Sherīm ṯaghāī* decided to leave him as he wasn't keen to go to Khurāsān. For Babur, Sherīm ṯaghāī's importance was unparalleled. He had sent all his family off and stayed unfettered. Yet, it must be remembered that Sherīm ṯaghāī showed some cowardliness after the defeat at Sar-i-pul (AD 1500) when Babur went back to defend Samarkand. The acts of cowardice were repeated several times over.

## Khusrau Shāh's Kinsman Joins Babur

Babur and his 300 men reached Qabādīān. Bāqī Chaghānīānī, a younger brother of Khusrau Shāh who was more Chaghānīān, Shahr-i-ṣafā, and Tīrmīẕ, sent the khatib of Qarshī to Babur. He certainly wanted to express their good wishes desiring an alliance. Bāqī Chaghānīānī had come himself to wait on Babur when they had crossed the Amū at the Aūbāj-ferry. As requested by Bāqī Chaghānīānī, Babur and his men moved down the river, opposite Tīrmīẕ. There stood fearlessly, the families, when intended to join Babur, laden with their goods. Once this was done, Babur and his men set out for Kāhmard and Bamyan. These places were held by Aḥmad-i-qāsim, the son of Khusrau Shāh's sister. The plan was clear. They wanted to leave the households safe in Fort Ajar of the Kāhmard-valley, and act to reinforce power wherever needed. When they reached Aībak, Yār-'alī Balāl joined Babur along with his men. He had fled from Khusrau Shāh. Before that, he had been with Babur. Babur has asserted in the *Baburnama* that he had been along with him during various battles. He had turned distant from Babur in his throneless* period and had gone to join Khusrau Shāh. He told Babur that the Moghūls in Khusrau Shāh's service had great conviction and faith in Babur. When Babur reached Zindān-valley, Qaṃbar-'alī Beg too came to him.

## Kāhmard

They reached Kāhmard after four marches and stayed in Ajar for a while. During this stay, Jahāngīr Mīrzā married Aī Begum, the daughter of Sulṯān Maḥmūd Mīrzā and Khān-zāda Begum. This arrangement was made between respective fathers in AD 1490. In the meantime, Bāqī Beg kept on telling Babur repeatedly that the two rulers in one country or two chiefs in one army are always a source of disorder. According to him, it crafted a foundation of discord leading to ruin.